

Registration fees	₹ 4800 (India) / US\$ 165 (USA) [price is based on currency exchange rates in various nations and regions]
Prerequisites	Microsoft Certified Azure Administrator Associate certification: Azure administrators implement, manage and monitor an organisation's Microsoft Azure environment or Microsoft Certified Azure Developer Associate certification: Azure developers design, build, test, and maintain cloud applications and services
Questions and format	40-60 questions • Multiple choice questions • Build list in sequence • Drag and drop • Hot area • Repeated answers • Short answers • Labs (I wrote four certification exams [AZ-400, AZ-900, AZ-500, AZ-104] in December 2020 from home, and was not asked to do lab work in any exam.)
Duration	180 minutes exam time / 210 minutes seat time (associate and expert job role exams)
Passing score	700/1000 (scaled score) The real percentage of questions that a candidate must answer correctly differs from exam to exam.
Medium of delivery	Online from your home or an authorised test centre
Open book	No
Exam content and objectives /skills measured	• Develop an instrumentation strategy (design and implement logging, design and implement telemetry, and integrate logging and monitoring solutions); https://docs.microsoft.com/en-us/learn/paths/az-400-develop-instrumentation-strategy/ • Develop a site reliability engineering (SRE) strategy (develop an actionable alerting strategy, design a failure prediction strategy, and design and implement a health check); https://docs.microsoft.com/en-us/learn/paths/az-400-develop-sre-strategy/ • Develop a security and compliance plan (design an authentication and authorisation strategy, design a sensitive information management strategy, develop security and compliance, and design governance enforcement mechanisms); https://docs.microsoft.com/en-us/learn/paths/az-400-develop-security-compliance-plan/ • Manage source control (develop a modern source control strategy, plan and implement branching strategies for the source code, configure repositories and integrate source control with tools); https://docs.microsoft.com/en-us/learn/paths/az-400-manage-source-control/ • Facilitate communication and collaboration (communicate deployment and release information with business stakeholders, generate DevOps process documentation, and automate communication with team members); https://docs.microsoft.com/en-us/learn/paths/az-400-facilitate-communication-collaboration/ • Define and implement continuous integration (design build automation, automation runbooks gallery, NuGet, JFrog, Artifactory), design an application infrastructure management strategy, implement a build strategy, maintain build strategy and design a process for standardising builds across the organisation; https://docs.microsoft.com/en-us/learn/paths/az-400-define-implement-continuous-integration/ • Define and implement a continuous delivery and release management strategy (develop deployment scripts and templates, implement an orchestration automation solution, and plan the deployment environment strategy)
Good reference books	Hands-on Azure DevOps: CI/CD Implementation for Mobile, Hybrid, and Web Applications Using Azure DevOps and Microsoft Azure (https://www.amazon.com/Hands-Azure-DevOps-Implementation-Applications-ebook/dp/B08BLG5QM4/); Agile, DevOps and Cloud Computing with Microsoft Azure: Hands-on DevOps Practices Implementation Using Azure DevOps (https://www.amazon.com/Agile-DevOps-Computing-Microsoft-Hands-ebook/dp/B07WXJ4TD9/)
Benefits	There are two-way benefits for organisations and their employees who have Azure DevOps skills. It creates awareness on what needs to be improved with respect to the implementation of DevOps practices in the organisation. It also enhances the organisation's culture and the mindset of its employees.
Free training	Yes
Schedule your exam	Exam AZ-400: Designing and Implementing Microsoft DevOps Solutions; https://docs.microsoft.com/en-us/learn/certifications/exams/az-400
My view	AZ-400 covers most of the topics that a DevOps/automation engineer needs to know. Azure DevOps services such as Azure Boards, Azure Repos, Azure Pipelines, Azure Artifacts and Azure Tests cover more or less all aspects of SDLC automation activities. It helps to get knowledge about what is possible and what best practices to implement while using Azure DevOps in DevOps practice implementation. The training under this certification covers release management/continuous delivery with Azure services as well as Kubernetes. For more details, visit https://docs.microsoft.com/en-us/learn/certifications/devops-engineer and https://docs.microsoft.com/en-us/learn/certifications/frequently-asked-questions